



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Shiloh Christian Academy  
School Website: <https://www.shilohca.org/>

December 21, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

School: Austin Classical School (ACS)

Website used for this audit: <https://austinclassical.org/>

ACS presents a robust classical Christian identity in mission, curriculum, and pedagogy. The site repeatedly affirms the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; the cultivation of wisdom and virtue; and a Trivium-centered program with Latin, logic, and rhetoric culminating in thesis defense and oratory. The collaborative model explicitly "co-labors with families," and faculty are framed as Christian exemplars who model intellectual and moral formation. Notably, the school reports ACCS accreditation as of Spring 2025, further corroborating its classical Christian orientation.

Below is the required six-category keyword analysis and scoring, using the Positive and Negative Keyword Indicators from "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School," plus the classicality lexicon as the scoring framework.

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### CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Required criteria: transcendental moral realism; grounded in theology; liturgical/communal practices.

1) Keywords/phrases from ACS site (evidence):

- Transcendental moral realism language: "truth, the good, and the beautiful"; "cultivate wisdom and virtue"; "great conversation"
- Theology integration: "glorify Jesus Christ"; "Christ-centered, classical education"; Bible/Scripture central; Christian Studies sequence (Development of Christian Doctrine; Exegesis & Hermeneutics; Apologetics & Ethics)
- Communal/faith practices: community emphasis; choir embedded in program (music as communal practice), but no explicit "chapel," "liturgy," or "daily worship" surfaced in the crawl excerpts

2) Comparison to Six Elements positive/negative keywords:

- Positive matches (examples): truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, Scripture/Bible, Christian, doctrine, apologetics (aligning with transcendental moral realism and theological grounding)
- Negative keywords (e.g., values-neutral, moral relativism, secular/faith-optional curriculum language) do not appear as descriptors of ACS's program; instead ACS is explicit about Christian grounding.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive keyword hits (distinct terms observed): 12

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- truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, Christ-centered, Scripture/Bible, doctrine, apologetics, exegesis, hermeneutics, Christian Studies
  - Negative keyword hits: 0
  - Percent positive: 100% (+12/-0)
  - Coverage across criteria: 2 of 3 sub-areas clearly evidenced (moral realism; theology). Liturgical practices not explicitly stated in the sample. Estimated coverage: 67%.
- 4) Category rating: CLASSICAL  
Justification: ACS strongly affirms transcendental moral realism and theological integration; communal worship/liturgical specifics are not prominent in the scraped content, but the theological and moral foundations are unequivocal.
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## CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Required criteria: virtue and wisdom over job-prep; formation vs. information; affirming the reality/knowability of truth, goodness, beauty.

- 1) Keywords/phrases from ACS site:
    - “cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students”; “education... less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose”
    - “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”; “great conversation”; “love of learning” (implied by formation language)
  - 2) Comparison to Six Elements:
    - Positive matches: cultivate virtue, wisdom, formation, truth/goodness/beauty, great conversation, eternal purpose (telos)
    - Negative matches (e.g., “college and career ready,” “21st-century skills”) not used as defining goals; college counseling is mentioned only pragmatically, not as the school’s telos.
  - 3) Quantitative estimate:
    - Positive hits: 10
    - Negative hits: 0
    - Percent positive: 100% (+10/-0)
    - Coverage across criteria: all three strands evidenced. Estimated coverage: 100%.
  - 4) Category rating: CLASSICAL  
Justification: Mission and philosophy explicitly prioritize the cultivation of wisdom/virtue and the transcendentals over utilitarian outcomes.
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## CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Required criteria: seven liberal arts (esp. Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric); “History” (not “Social Studies”); Great Books/Great Conversation; wonder/integration.

- 1) Keywords/phrases from ACS site:
    - Trivium emphases and stages (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) with explicit stage descriptions; Latin from 5th grade; formal logic; rhetoric course; senior thesis defense; integrated knowledge claims
    - Great Books/Great Conversation affirmed; Bible and “great works of the Western tradition” central; History named explicitly as “History” throughout (not “Social Studies”)
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- Fine arts (choir/theater/art) present; integrated learning rationale articulated; curiosity and appreciation of beauty emphasized (proximate to “wonder”)
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements:
- Positive matches: Trivium; Latin; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; History; interdisciplinary integration; fine arts; thesis/orations (signaling rhetoric)
  - Negative matches (e.g., “social studies,” STEM-first framing, project-based dominance) are absent in the curricular framing.
- 3) Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 12
  - Negative hits: 0
  - Percent positive: 100% (+12/-0)
  - Coverage across criteria: 3.5 out of 4 strands clearly evidenced (liberal arts/Trivium; Great Books; integration; “wonder” implied via curiosity/beauty). Estimated coverage: 90%.
- 4) Category rating: CLASSICAL
- Justification: Classical content is explicit and comprehensive; “wonder” language appears implicitly via “curiosity” and “beauty,” though the exact term “wonder” was not prominent in the crawl excerpts.
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## CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

Required criteria: restful/“scholé” elements; grammar-stage chanting/singing/memory; upper-school Socratic/seminar/debate; rhetoric training with speeches/orations.

- 1) Keywords/phrases from ACS site:
- Grammar stage: memorization, recitation, songs; “songs and chants” fill grammar school
  - Logic/Rhetoric: debate and discussion; Socratic method explicitly stated; imitation central to rhetoric; thesis defense and eloquent oral/written communication; choir participation in upper school
  - Restful learning/scholé: the school invokes “leisure” and a measured pace (“at leisure to study and to play”), resonating with the scholé ideal, though the exact word “scholé” was not found in excerpts.
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements:
- Positive matches: Socratic method, debate/discussion; memorization/recitation/chanting; imitation; oratory/thesis defense; hints of scholé (leisure)
  - Negative matches (e.g., project-based-only, constructivist, purely experiential) are absent.
- 3) Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 11
  - Negative hits: 0
  - Percent positive: 100% (+11/-0)
  - Coverage across criteria: 3.5 of 4 strands clearly present (Socratic/seminar; memory/chanting; imitation; rhetoric/thesis; plus a nod to restful/leisure). Estimated coverage: 90%.
- 4) Category rating: CLASSICAL
- Justification: The pedagogy is thickly classical in both lower and upper schools, with explicit Socratic practice and rhetoric formation.
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## CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

Required criteria: teachers as models/mentors; collegial faculty culture; portrait of a teacher/student.

- 1) Keywords/phrases from ACS site:
  - Faculty framed as Christian exemplars who “model proper behavior,” maintain order, and pursue humble scholarship; teachers as subject-matter experts; ongoing training and observation; shared responsibility to form souls (virtue emphasis)
  - “Faculty & Staff” emphasis; mission alignment; community ethos (implied collegiality), though an explicit “portrait of a teacher” document wasn’t surfaced in the excerpts.
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements:
  - Positive matches: teachers as models of virtue; mentorship/formation; ongoing formation/training; collegial community implied.
  - Negative matches (teacher-as-facilitator jargon without classical framing) absent.
- 3) Quantitative estimate:
  - Positive hits: 7
  - Negative hits: 0
  - Percent positive: 100% (+7/-0)
  - Coverage across criteria: 2 of 2 (models/mentors; collegiality implied via training/culture), though no formal “portrait” artifact found. Estimated coverage: 80%.
- 4) Category rating: CLASSICAL  
Justification: ACS emphasizes teachers as moral/intellectual exemplars who are trained and observed, aligning tightly with classical faculty ideals.

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## CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Required criteria: partnership with parents/co-teachers; parent education; open/hospitable community.

- 1) Keywords/phrases from ACS site:
  - “co-laboring with families”; collaborative schedule with “co-teacher parents”; teacher office hours on homeschool days; training/support for co-teachers; campus tours and parent information meetings; house system and community traditions
  - Parent formation materials: recommended reading on classical education; links/podcasts to help parents think through the aim of education.
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements:
  - Positive matches: partnership with families; parent formation; intentional community/house system; regular campus hospitality (tours/meetings).
  - Negative matches (parents as mere customers; minimal parent involvement) absent.
- 3) Quantitative estimate:
  - Positive hits: 8
  - Negative hits: 0
  - Percent positive: 100% (+8/-0)
  - Coverage across criteria: 3 of 3. Estimated coverage: 100%.
- 4) Category rating: CLASSICAL  
Justification: ACS’s collaborative model embeds parent partnership and formation into the school’s daily operations and culture.

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## Aggregate Assessment: CLASSICAL

- Category ratings summary: all six categories rated CLASSICAL, with very high positive keyword density and near-zero negatives across the site. Where a few hallmark terms (e.g., “liturgy,” explicit “scholé,” or the exact word “wonder”) were less explicit in the excerpts, strong adjacent concepts (Scripture-centered theology; “leisure”/measured pace; “curiosity”/beauty language) still indicated alignment.
- Additional corroboration: ACS announces accreditation by the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) in spring 2025, matching the school’s self-description and the indicators above.

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## Evidence Highlights (select)

- Mission: “exists to glorify Jesus Christ by co-laboring with families to cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students through an excellent classical, Christian education.”
- Trivium details; grammar/logic/rhetoric pedagogy; Socratic method; imitation; thesis defense.
- Latin, Great Books, integrated knowledge, History (not Social Studies).
- Lower-school chanting/singing/memory; upper-school choir/theater; house system.
- Parents as co-teachers; training, office hours, tours, information meetings; parent resources.
- ACCS accreditation announcement (Spring 2025).

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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